

FADE IN

EXT. BEACH - DUSK

MEDIUM SHOT

CHRIS, a large half-crab, half-man hybrid, sits on a large rock next to SAMUEL, a young man in his early 20s wearing a shirt that says "Sunny Scoops Ice Cream" on the back.

A nearby fire illuminates both of them.

Samuel leans against Chris' red carapace while rubbing on one of his shoulders, barely able to reach it with how tall Chris is.

CHRIS

Wow, it's been nearly thirteen lunar cycles since we became friends.

SAMUEL

I think you mean a year.

CHRIS

(playful)

I was just fine counting time using the moon before you came around.

Chris lightly hits Samuel's stomach with his massive claw.

Samuel recoils at first before wrapping his arms around Chris's claw, his face flushing with a peach color.

Chris chuckles and lets Samuel rub his claw. As Samuel continues to rub Chris's claw, Chris turns his head, scratching it with his other claw.

CHRIS (CONT'D)

I'm still surprised how much you still love to touch them.

SAMUEL

Are you kidding? It's amazing! It's like touching a giant bug.

CHRIS
Am I a giant bug?

SAMUEL
Well, actually...

Samuel pauses for a moment.

SAMUEL (CONT'D)
Don't worry about it. It's complicated.

EXT. BEACH - NIGHT

The fire is barely hanging on, and only a few embers swirl around the charred wood.

CHRIS (O.S)
You wanna know something, dude?

SAMUEL (O.S)
Yeah?

LONG SHOT OF STARRY SKY

CHRIS (O.S)
Of all the shores I could have been born on. Under all the skies I could have existed under. I get to be here with you under this sky, on this shore.

SAMUEL (O.S)
I'm happy I get to see these stars with you.

CHRIS (O.S)
It's funny, because humans used to use stars to navigate, right?

SAMUEL (O.S)
Like the North Star. It's right there.

Samuel points towards the giant star ahead of them, with only his hand being visible.

CHRIS (O.S)
North star. Yeah, you're like the North Star to me.

CUT TO:

EXT. BEACH - CONTINUOUS

MEDIUM WAIST SHOT

Chris and Samuel lay on the sand.

Samuel lowers his hand, his face barely visible under the starlight.

He smiles contentedly, his eyes relaxed.

SAMUEL
How so?

CHRIS
You've been the one to guide me. Lead me on where to go.
I wouldn't know anything real about humans if it weren't for
you.

SAMUEL
I would never have had such a great time without meeting
you!
Or have the confidence I do.
Or feel loved the same way I do...

Samuel turns towards Chris and climbs towards his head.
Placing a hand on his chest, Samuel faces Chris.

SAMUEL
I love you, Chris.

Chris's eyestalks jitter and flick rapidly.

CHRIS
I love you too, Samuel.

Samuel moves his mouth towards Chris's, and Chris
instinctively closes his eyestalks.

Samuel kisses Chris.
Chris's mouth appendages softly caress Samuel's lips.

FADE OUT